25900817

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR /IMPROVEMENT/ REAPPEARANCE
EXAMINATION NOVEMBER 2025
FIRST SEMESTER
Multi-Disciplinary Courses (MDC) - MG1MDCENG101 - **NARRATIVES OF HUMOUR**

Scheme of Valuation

Duration: 1.5 Hours **Maximum Marks: 50**

Part A

Multiple Choice Questions.
Answer All Questions. Each Question carries **1** mark

1. c) To enhance their uniqueness and create opportunities for humour [CO1, CO2, CO3]
2. a) Pushpa [CO1, CO2,CO3]
3. c) Short and stocky build [CO1, CO2,CO3]
4. d) Jerome is the most mischievous character in the group [CO4]
5. b) It represents Remy's dream of becoming a chef and showcases his culinary talents. [CO5]

(5 x 1 = 5)

PART B

Objective Type Questions
Answer any **10** Questions. Each Question carries **1** mark

6. Incongruity between the expected and the real. [CO1, CO2, CO3]
7. Pacing - the rhythm of humour - slowing down and speeding up in order to create humour – plays with expectations - Eg. My friend told me he is learning the art of camouflage. I haven't seen him since. [CO1, CO2, CO3]
8. Satirical and ironical story on social vanity [CO1, CO2, CO3]
9. Book - an immediate success - became a classic of English literature - known for its timeless humour and general satire. [CO4]
10. Andrew - an aspiring editor and writer - wants to get his manuscript published - If Margaret gets deported to Canada, he will lose his job at the publishing house and will have to return to his family business with his estranged father. [CO5]
11. Bruce misuses his god- like powers to sabotage his rival, Evan Baxter, during a live broadcast makes Evan speak gibberish on air - embarrass himself in front of the entire city. [CO5]
12. 1936 [CO5]
13. Toby [CO4]
14. As one of the last great silent films, ‘Modern Times’ stands as a bridge between silent cinema and the emerging era of sound films. [CO5]
15. 1939 [CO1, CO2, CO3]
16. Sitcom - shortened version of situational comedy - a genre of comedy television series - revolves around a fixed set of characters who navigate humorous, often exaggerated situations. [CO5]
17. Margaret wanted to prevent her deportation to her native Canada from New York and save her career. Hence, she agreed to help Andrew. [CO5]

(10 x 1 = 10)

PART C

Short Answer Questions

Answer any **5** Questions in 50 words. Each Question carries **2** marks

18. Conversation about 'dog biscuits' offers a sharp contrast to his heroic daydreams - presents Mitty as a meek, ordinary man, not a hero of his imaginary world. [CO1, CO2, CO3]
19. 'Big Bang Theory' combines complex scientific references with everyday humour - appeal to a wide audience - science content is authentic - presented through humorous dialogue - contrasted with the intellectual vanity and social awkwardness of the physicists - leads to situational comedy - Penny becomes a contrast to the scientific jargon used by scientists – humorous character sketch. [CO5]
20. 'The Bear' explores the absurdities of human behaviour through humorous situations - encounter between the mourning widow, Popova and the intruding neighbor, Smirnov - quarrels lead to instances of physical comedy like breaking of chairs exaggerated arguments and physical confrontations like the pistol duel. [CO4]
21. Howard's over confidence regarding women - introduced in the early episodes - adds to the dynamic interplay of personalities - enriches the comedic landscape - character reveals social awkwardness, immaturity and lack of understanding of women's perspectives. [CO5]
22. Mr. Bean's silent and physical humour, 'travels' across different cultures - rarely speaks and relies largely on physical comedy to convey his absurdities - character's unusual appearance - facial expressions - body language generate universal humour - transcends linguistic borders. [CO5]
23. Sai Kiran discusses the issue of colourism within the context of Indian marriages - addresses societal attitudes and personal experiences - fair skin is much valued in the arranged marriage system. [CO5]
24. Mr. Bean - socially unaware misfit - behaves strangely in weddings and funeral ceremonies - incongruity between the expected normal behaviour and Mr. Bean's physical actions, facial expressions and unusual appearance - rarely speaks and relies largely on physical comedy to convey his absurdities. [CO5]
25. Jim Carrey's trademark physical comedy - significant source of humour in Bruce Almighty - Known for his elastic facial expressions - exaggerated body movements - infuses the role with kinetic energy - Egs: Bruce causes a monkey to emerge from a man's pants - parts a bowl of tomato soup as if it were the Red Sea. [CO5]

(5 x 2 = 10)

PART D

Short Essay Questions

Answer any **2** Questions in 150 Words. Each Question carries **5** marks

26. Emperor - excessively fond of new clothes - deceived by two swindlers - pretend to weave him a magnificent outfit - invisible to anyone unfit for their position or stupid - Emperor's folly in believing in the rogues - pretensions of the courtiers - deceptive praise showered by ministers to hide their ineptitude or stupidity - human tendency to pretend or deceive. [CO1, CO2, CO3]
27. Physical comedy or slap stick - key element in humour - Jerome's characters are clumsy and incompetent leading to comical mishaps - packing scene, the friends pack up for the trip and end up in utter chaos with broken dishes, squashed tomatoes and misplaced items - illustrates the ineptitude of the characters - physical comedy - a visual and dynamic form of comic effect. [CO4]
28. Anton Ego - cynical food critic - firm critic of Gusteau and his belief that 'anyone can ‘cook' - negative reviews affected Gusteau's reputation and life - Remy's entry as cook at the restaurant

leads to a sequence of humorous events - Remy controls Linguini, Gusteau's heir and generates numerous humorous events. [CO5]

29. 'Dark Skin and Getting Married' - Sai Kiran addresses the cultural biases and societal expectations that uphold fair skin as a prerequisite for desirability in the arranged marriage system - discusses the issue of colourism within the context of Indian marriages - addresses societal attitudes and personal experiences related to skin colour and marriage in India - a mix of personal reflections and broader societal observations - discusses the emotional and psychological challenges faced by individuals with darker skin tones - urges a re-evaluation of these deeply ingrained prejudices. [CO5]

(2 x 5 = 10)

Part E

Essay Questions

Answer any **1** Question in 300 Words Each Question carries 15 marks.

30. Satire - a form of humour - uses wit, exaggeration and ridicule to criticize or expose flaws in society, politics or individuals - Parody - humorous imitation of a work, style or genre, often exaggerating its characteristics for comedic effect - Satire can be a powerful tool for conveying important messages while also making readers laugh - good satire should have a distinctive voice - should balance the art of point and pointlessness - a well-crafted punch line or satire can expose absurd truths about society - use of absurdity, incongruity, quirks, humorous personalities, pacing etc are essential for creating humour - satires laugh at social vanities and follies as in 'The Emperor's New Clothes ' - criticism of industrial age or modern consumerism or intellectual pomp as seen in 'Modern Times' or 'Big Bang Theory'. [CO1, CO2, CO3]

31. 'Three Men in a Boat ' - the comic expedition by middle class Victorians up the Thames to Oxford. Jerome K Jerome employs various forms of humour to critique the trivialities and absurdities of Victorian society - exaggerated concern of the characters over minor inconveniences is a rich source of humour - Eg. The narrator's hypochondria and obsessive self-diagnosis - physical comedy or slapstick is a key element in the humour of the novel - clumsiness and incompetence of characters lead to comical mishaps - Eg. the packing scene resulting in total chaos - the physical humour in the scenes provides a visual and dynamic form of comedy – novelist employs absurdity, hyperbole, word play and character based humour to create an insighful and entertaining narrative. [CO4]

(1 x 15 = 15)